

A Seminole Creation Story & Other Tales

核心词汇

- **faith** n. 信仰；信念；信任；忠实
- **reflect** v. 反映；反射，照出；表达；显示；反省
- **view** n. 观点，意见；视力；视野；视线；风景，美景；风景照；风景画 v. 认为；观察；认为
- **concede** v. 承认；(比赛结束前) 认输，退让
- **focus** n. 焦点；中心；清晰；焦距 v. 使集中；使聚焦
- **future** n. 未来；前途；期货；将来时 adj. 将来的，未来的
- **refuge** n. 避难；避难所；庇护 vt. 给予... 庇护；接纳... 避难 vi. 避难；逃避
- **soil** n. 土地；土壤；国家；粪便；务农；温床 v. 弄脏；污辱
- **saving** n. 节约；挽救；存款 adj. 节约的；挽救的；补偿的；保留的 prep. 考虑到；除之外
- **article** n. 文章，论文；物件；条款
- **minority** n. 少数民族；少数派；未成年 adj. 少数的；属于少数派的
- **perpetual** adj. 永久的，永恒的，长期的
- **foremost** adj. 最重要的；最先的 adv. 首先；居于首位地
- **local** adj. 地方的，当地的；局部的
- **threshold** n. 入口；门槛；开始；极限；临界值
- **abandon** v. 离弃，丢弃；遗弃，抛弃；放弃
- **retreat** n. 撤退；休息寓所；撤退 v. 撤退；退避；向后倾
- **authentic** adj. 真正的，真实的；可信的
- **yield** v. 屈服；出产，产生；放弃 n. 产量；收益
- **resident** n. 居民，常住者 adj. 居住的
- **cooperative** adj. 合作的；合作社的 n. 合作社
- **include** v. 包括，包含
- **source** n. 来源；水源；原始资料

- **goodness** int. 天哪 n. 善良, 优秀; 精华, 养分
- **garden** n. 花园; 菜园 v. 栽培花木
- **commend** v. 推荐; 称赞; 把... 委托
- **original** n. 原件; 原作; 原物; 原型 adj. 原始的; 最初的; 独创的; 新颖的
- **hospitality** n. 好客; 殷勤
- **ecology** n. 生态学
- **warm** adj. 温暖的; 热情的 v. 同情; 激动; 变温暖 n. 取暖; 加热
- **nation** n. 国家; 民族; 国民
- **register** v. 登记; 注册; 记录; 挂号邮寄; 把... 挂号; 正式提出 n. 登记; 注册; 记录; 寄存器; 登记簿
- **framework** n. 框架, 骨架; 结构, 构架
- **ability** n. 能力, 智能;
- **translation** n. 翻译; 译文; 转化; 调任
- **transmit** v. 传输; 传播; 发射; 传达; 遗传
- **enemy** n. 敌人, 仇敌; 敌军 adj. 敌人的, 敌方的
- **dignity** n. (举止, 态度等的) 庄严, 端庄; 尊贵, 尊严
- **title** n. 书名; 标题; 头衔, 称号
- **ally** n. 同盟国; 伙伴; 同盟者; 助手 v. 使联盟; 使联合
- **weave** v. 编织; 编排; 使迂回前进 n. 织物; 织法; 编织式样
- **underlying** adj. 潜在的; 根本的; 在下面的; 优先的 v. 放在... 的下面; 为... 的基础; 优先于 (underlie 的 ing 形式)
- **conception** n. 概念, 观念; 设想, 构想
- **protect** v. (from) 保护, 保卫
- **bush** n. 灌木; 矮树丛 v. 以灌木装饰; 使... 精疲力竭 adj. 如灌木般长得低矮的; 粗野的
- **support** v. 支撑; 支持; 赡养; 维持 n. 支持; 拥护; 赞同
- **voice** n. 声音; 嗓音; 意见, 发言权; 语态
- **turbulent** adj. 骚乱的, 混乱的; 狂暴的; 吵闹的; 激流的, 湍流的
- **faithful** adj. 守信的, 忠实的; 如实的

- **literary** adj. 文学的；书面的；精通文学的

双语正文

This **article** shares **authentic** Seminole traditional tales, whose **title** honors the **original** oral stories passed down for centuries. The Seminole **nation**, a proud Indigenous **minority** and longtime **resident** of the U.S. Southeast, found **refuge** in Florida's fertile **soil** in the 1700s while fleeing **turbulent** wars to the north. They were later joined by escaped enslaved people who became their close **ally** as the Black Seminole community. The Seminole refused to **concede** their lands to the U.S. government, never to **abandon** their homelands even during the brutal Seminole Wars of the 19th century, earning the self-given name Yat'siminoli, a **translation** meaning "Unconquered People" that embodies their unbroken **dignity** and **perpetual** respect for the natural world. Their **faith** in the Creator's plan guides every part of daily life, and their spiritual **conception** of the world **reflects** deep ties to **ecology**, with stories that **weave** together human, animal, and divine realms to **transmit** core values across generations.

本文分享了真实可信的塞米诺尔族传统故事，故事的标题是为了致敬数百年来口耳相传的原始口述版本。塞米诺尔民族是充满自豪感的原住民少数群体，也是美国东南部的长期居民，18

世纪时他们为躲避北方的动荡战乱，在佛罗里达的肥沃土地上找到了避难所。后来逃脱奴役的黑人也加入了他们，成为塞米诺尔人的亲密盟友，共同组成了黑塞米诺尔社群。塞米诺尔人拒绝向美国政府割让土地，哪怕是在 19 世纪残酷的塞米诺尔战争期间也从未抛弃故土，因此给自己取名为 Yat'siminoli，翻译过来意为“不可征服的民族”，这个名字体现了他们从未受损的尊严，以及对自然世界永恒的敬畏。他们对创世主安排的信仰指引着日常生活的方方面面，他们的精神世界观反映出与生态学的深刻联结，故事将人类、动物和神界编织在一起，代代传承核心价值观。

These tales **focus** on the **goodness** of the Creator, the collective duty to **protect** the land that sustains all life, and timeless lessons for the **future**. For the Seminole, Florida's sprawling landscapes are no empty **garden** but a living entity that **yields**

food, medicine, and shelter, so **foremost** among their values is reciprocal care for all living beings. The first of the three most well-known stories details the creation of the world: when the Grandfather of all things finished shaping the earth, he placed every animal inside a giant shell resting atop the highest mountains, just at the **threshold** of the world's official completion. He **commended** the panther, Coo-wah-Chobee, for its quiet patience and unmatched strength, choosing it to be the first creature to walk the new earth. When a tree root eventually cracked the shell, the panther waited too long to move, so Wind, a **faithful** servant of the Creator, helped the panther exit first, followed by birds, bears, deer, snakes, otters, and thousands of other creatures. The Creator then established a **framework** of roles for each being: the panther clan would hold sacred knowledge of law and healing, Wind would serve all life as the air all creatures breathe, and birds would oversee that all beings occupy their right place on the land. The story emphasizes that **cooperative** care for one another and the natural world is the only path to long-term survival.

这些故事聚焦于创世主的善、保护孕育所有生命的土地的集体责任，以及面向未来的永恒教训。对塞米诺尔人来说，佛罗里达广袤的土地不是空荡的花园，而是能出产食物、药材和居所的活的生命体，因此他们价值观中最重要的一点就是对所有生命的互惠关怀。三个最知名的故事里，第一个详细讲述了世界的起源：当万物之祖完成了地球的塑造后，他把所有动物都放在一个巨壳里，巨壳安放在最高的山顶，正处于世界正式完工的临界点。他称赞黑豹库瓦乔比沉静耐心、力量无双，选它作为第一个行走在新地球上的生物。后来树根撑裂了巨壳，黑豹却迟迟没有挪动，因此创世主的忠实仆人"风"帮助黑豹第一个走了出来，跟在后面的是鸟类、熊、鹿、蛇、水獭和成千上万种其他生物。随后创世主为每个生命都设立了角色框架：黑豹部族将掌握律法和疗愈的神圣知识，风会作为所有生物呼吸的空气为众生服务，鸟类则负责监督所有生灵都在土地上占据自己应有的位置。这个故事强调，协作关照彼此和自然世界是长期生存的唯一路径。

The second tale explains the origin of the night sky, which **local** Seminole **view** as a spirit path for deceased community members. Good souls travel the Milky Way to

the City of the West, while bad souls remain trapped under **bush** and earth, never to walk the mortal world again. The Seminole say the Milky Way glows brighter after a beloved community member passes, lighting the path for their journey. This story carries an **underlying** message: one must live with integrity, speak with a kind **voice**, never steal or lie, and act bravely for their people to earn a place on the spirit path. Even during solar eclipse events, the community comes together to make loud noise to scare off the toad-frog that bites the sun, a tradition that **registers** their collective will to **support** one another against unseen harms. They do not **retreat** from challenges, using their collective **ability** to face whatever threat comes their way.

第二个故事解释了夜空的起源，当地的塞米诺尔人认为夜空是离世族人的灵魂通道。善良的灵魂会沿着银河前往西方之城，而邪恶的灵魂会被困在灌木和泥土之下，永远无法再踏入人间。塞米诺尔人说，当深受爱戴的族人离世后，银河会变得更亮，为他们的旅途照亮道路。这个故事隐含着一个深层信息：人必须品行正直、言语温和友善，不偷盗不撒谎，勇敢为族人付出，才能在灵魂通道上赢得一席之地。哪怕是发生日食的时候，整个社群都会聚在一起制造巨响，吓跑啃食太阳的蟾蜍，这个传统彰显了他们互相支持、共同对抗未知伤害的集体意志。他们面对挑战从不退缩，会用集体的能力迎接任何到来的威胁。

The third tale follows Chok-fee, a skilled young hunter whose grandmother warns him not to travel south, but curiosity leads him to a hidden pair of lodges deep in the forest. The headless man inside greets him with **warm hospitality**, explaining that an Unga, a giant man-faced bird that is his sworn **enemy**, stole his head to force him to allow the Unga to marry his daughter. Chok-fee agrees to help, tracks the Unga to a tall cypress tree, kills it with his arrow, and returns the head just before midday to save the man's life. As a reward, the man tells Chok-fee that all deer in the land are his, that he will never go hungry if he waits four full days before entering the small lodge where his daughter waits. But Chok-fee's curiosity gets the better of him, and he peeks inside on the third day. The girl vanishes into the sky to become the Morning Star, and the gift of **saving** the effort of long hunting trips is lost forever. If Chok-fee had waited, the Seminole would have all they need just by wishing for it;

instead, they work hard to hunt and tend the land, a lesson that no shortcut ever yields lasting rewards.

第三个故事的主角是年轻的优秀猎人乔克菲，他的祖母警告他不要往南走，但好奇心还是驱使他走到了森林深处两座隐秘的小屋前。屋里的无头男子热情好客地接待了他，解释说自己的死敌昂加（一种长着人脸的巨鸟）偷走了他的头，逼他同意把女儿嫁给昂加。乔克菲同意帮忙，一路追踪昂加到了一棵高大的柏树上，用箭射死了昂加，赶在正午前把头颅送了回去，救了男子的命。作为回报，男子告诉乔克菲，这片土地上的所有鹿都属于他，只要他等满四天再走进女儿所在的小屋，就永远不会挨饿，还能省去长途狩猎的力气。但乔克菲没能克制住好奇心，第三天就往屋里偷看了。女孩消失在天空中变成了启明星，这份能省去长途狩猎辛劳的礼物也就永远丢失了。如果乔克菲当初愿意等待，塞米诺尔人只要许愿就能得到所有需要的东西；但事与愿违，他们必须辛勤狩猎、耕种土地，这个故事告诉我们，没有任何捷径能带来长久的回报。

These **literary** treasures are a vital **source** of Seminole cultural heritage that **include** lessons that resonate far beyond their community. They remind readers that Indigenous stories are not just myth, but living records of how to live in harmony with the natural world. Today, cultural preservation groups and scholars alike **support** efforts to document and share these stories, as they offer important insights into sustainable living for people across the globe. The Seminole have never **yielded** their right to their land and culture, continuing to share their stories to keep their heritage alive for generations to come.

这些文学瑰宝是塞米诺尔文化遗产的重要来源，包含的道理能引发远超出其社群范围的共鸣。它们提醒读者，原住民故事不只是神话，更是如何与自然世界和谐共处的活的记录。如今，文化保护组织和学者都支持记录和分享这些故事的工作，因为它们能为全球人类的可持续生活提供重要的启发。塞米诺尔人从未放弃对自己土地和文化的权利，他们会继续分享这些故事，让自己的文化遗产世代传承下去。